ENGLISH B1 · EXERCISE WORKBOOK

Past Continuous

Printable practice for Past Continuous en Inglés B1. No explanations or solutions interrupt the work pages.

THIS DOCUMENT

Exercise workbook

50 learning decisions arranged in progressive stages. Write directly on the page and consult the separate answer key only after completing a stage.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Use the complete guide to understand the concept, this workbook to practise, and the answer key to diagnose each decision.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

01 · PRACTICE STAGE

Reconoce la forma correcta

Elige la opción correcta de past continuous para cada situación.

A1 · UNA LLAMADA INESPERADA

I ___ a shower when my phone rang.

OPTIONS was having · were having · had · am having

A2 · EN LA OFICINA

What ___ you ___ when the meeting started?

OPTIONS were / doing · was / doing · did / do · are / doing

A3 · UNA TORMENTA SORPRESA

We ___ in the park when it started to rain.

OPTIONS were walking · was walking · walked · are walking

A4 · LA NOCHE DEL ACCIDENTE

She ___ to music while her brother was driving.

OPTIONS was listening · were listening · listened · is listening

A5 · A LAS 11 DE LA NOCHE

The children ___ when we finally got home.

OPTIONS were sleeping · was sleeping · slept · are sleeping

A6 · CONVERSACIÓN DE AMIGOS

Did you see the accident? No, I ___ in the other direction.

OPTIONS was looking · were looking · looked · look

A7 · UNA REUNIÓN DE TRABAJO

While the manager ___ the report, the clients arrived.

OPTIONS was presenting · were presenting · presented · presents

A8 · EL PARTIDO DE FÚTBOL

It ___ heavily when the referee stopped the match.

OPTIONS was raining · were raining · rained · rains

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

02 · PRACTICE STAGE

Was/were + acción simultánea

Completa con la forma correcta de past continuous para cada sujeto.

B1 · DOMINGO POR LA TARDE

While Maria _____ the house, her husband _____ in the garden.

OPTIONS Gap 1: was cleaning / were cleaning / cleaned / is cleaning · Gap 2: was working / were working / worked / is working

B2 · LA CONFERENCIA

The speaker _____ when the lights suddenly _____ off.

OPTIONS Gap 1: was talking / were talking / talked / has talked · Gap 2: went / were going / was going / go

B3 · EN EL RESTAURANTE

We _____ our meal when the fire alarm _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: were enjoying / was enjoying / enjoyed / enjoy · Gap 2: went off / was going off / were going off / goes off

B4 · UNA NOCHE DE TRABAJO

I _____ on my essay while my roommates _____ loudly in the living room.

OPTIONS Gap 1: was working / were working / worked / am working · Gap 2: were laughing / was laughing / laughed / laugh

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

03 · PRACTICE STAGE

La noche del apagón

Completa la historia eligiendo la forma verbal correcta (past continuous o past simple).

C1 · ELIGE LA FORMA CORRECTA PARA COMPLETAR ESTA HISTORIA.

It was a stormy evening last October. I _____ (study) at my desk when the electricity suddenly _____ (go) out. The whole neighborhood _____ (lose) power. Outside, the wind _____ (blow) and the rain _____ (fall) hard. I _____ (look) for some candles when I heard a knock at the door. My neighbor _____ (stand) there with a flashlight, looking scared.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

am studying · blew · blows · falls · fell · goes · gone · look · looked · loses · lost · stands · stood · studied · was blowing · was falling · was going · was looking · was losing · was standing · was studying · went · were blowing · were falling · were looking · were losing · were standing · were studying

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

04 · PRACTICE STAGE

Escribe sin opciones

Escribe la forma verbal correcta (past continuous o past simple) según el contexto.

D1 · ESCRIBE LA FORMA VERBAL CORRECTA PARA CADA VERBO EN PARÉNTESIS.

Yesterday afternoon was quite eventful. At 4 pm I _____ (work) from home when my friend _____ (call) me. While we _____ (talk), I heard a loud noise outside. I _____ (look) out the window and saw a car accident. The drivers _____ (argue) in the street.

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STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

05 · PRACTICE STAGE

Producción guiada

Escribe oraciones completas combinando past continuous y past simple.

E1 · UNA INTERRUPCIÓN

Describe qué estabas haciendo cuando sonó tu teléfono ayer (usa past continuous + when + past simple).

_____
_____

E2 · DOS ACCIONES SIMULTÁNEAS

Describe dos cosas que tú y otra persona hacían al mismo tiempo (usa while + past continuous).

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_____

E3 · UN MOMENTO ESPECÍFICO

Describe qué estabas haciendo a las 10 pm anoche (usa past continuous + time expression).

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_____

E4 · ESTABLECER ESCENARIO

Escribe 2 oraciones de past continuous para establecer el escenario de una historia (clima, personas, etc.).

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STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

06 · PRACTICE STAGE

Misión: Cuéntame tu día

Escribe 3 oraciones sobre ayer combinando past continuous y past simple.

F1 · TU HISTORIA

Escribe lo que estabas haciendo ayer a una hora específica (e.g., at 7 pm).

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_____
_____

F2 · TU HISTORIA

Cuéntame algo que te interrumpió mientras hacías algo ayer (past continuous + when + past simple).

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_____

F3 · TU HISTORIA

Describe dos cosas simultáneas que tú y alguien más hacían ayer (while + past continuous).

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F4 · REGISTRO Y CONTEXTO 08

Actividad 08. Sitúa «She wasn't feeling well, so she went home early.» en un contexto concreto -mensaje, conversación, relato o explicación-. Indica qué parte conservarías y qué adaptarías para mantener «No se sentía bien, así que se fue a casa temprano.».

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F5 · MICROTEXTO 09: PRINCIPIO, DESARROLLO Y CIERRE

Actividad 09. Escribe tres oraciones: presenta una situación, integra «Acción en progreso en el pasado» o una variante válida y cierra con una consecuencia relacionada con «was/were + -ing · She was reading a book.».

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F6 · RECUPERACIÓN ACTIVA 10

Actividad 10. Cubre la guía. Escribe de memoria la fórmula de Past Continuous, recupera «Acción interrumpida» y crea otro ejemplo con vocabulario distinto. Después verifica ambos.

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F7 · RECONSTRUCCIÓN 11: DEL SIGNIFICADO A LA FORMA

Actividad 11. Sin copiar, reconstruye una oración que comunique «was/were + -ing - She was reading a book.». Después compárala con «Acción en progreso en el pasado» y subraya la señal que controla la estructura.

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F8 · CONTRASTE MÍNIMO 12: DOS LECTURAS CERCANAS

Actividad 12. Compara «Acción interrumpida» con «I was working when the power went out.». Explica qué cambia entre «P.Cont + when + P.Simple - I was cooking when he arrived.» y «Estaba trabajando cuando se fue la luz. - Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple)» y escribe un tercer ejemplo que mantenga el primer patrón.

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F9 · TRANSFORMACIÓN CONTROLADA 13

Actividad 13. Toma «Misma idea, orden diferente» y cambia solamente una variable pertinente -persona, tiempo, cantidad o referente-. Ajusta todas las palabras dependientes y explica cada modificación.

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_____

F10 · DIÁLOGO BREVE 14: PREGUNTA Y RESPUESTA

Actividad 14. Crea un diálogo de tres turnos que prepare el contexto de «I was working when the power went out.». La respuesta debe resultar natural y el último turno debe retomar «Estaba trabajando cuando se fue la luz. - Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple)» sin repetir toda la frase.

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F11 · CLÍNICA DE ERRORES 15

Actividad 15. Analiza este error frecuente: «"While I studied, she was cooking" ☒ -> "While I was studying, she was cooking" ☒ — ambas acciones simultáneas usan continuous.». Reescribe una versión correcta dentro de dos oraciones conectadas y explica en qué paso se originó el problema.

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F12 · COHESIÓN 16: UNIR DOS EJEMPLOS

Actividad 16. Conecta «What were you doing at 8 pm last night?» y «While I was driving, I heard the news.» en un microtexto coherente. Añade el conector necesario y evita referencias ambiguas.

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F13 · EXPLICACIÓN DOCENTE 17

Actividad 17. Explica Past Continuous a otra persona usando «They were watching a movie when it started to rain.». Incluye la fórmula, una decisión y una advertencia sobre un error frecuente.

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F14 · REGISTRO Y CONTEXTO 18

Actividad 18. Sitúa «While I was driving, I heard the news.» en un contexto concreto -mensaje, conversación, relato o explicación-. Indica qué parte conservarías y qué adaptarías para mantener «Mientras conducía, escuché la noticia. - Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple)».

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_____
_____

F15 · MICROTEXTO 19: PRINCIPIO, DESARROLLO Y CIERRE

Actividad 19. Escribe tres oraciones: presenta una situación, integra «The kids were sleeping when we arrived.» o una variante válida y cierra con una consecuencia relacionada con «Los niños estaban durmiendo cuando llegamos. - Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple)».

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_____
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F16 · RECUPERACIÓN ACTIVA 20

Actividad 20. Cubre la guía. Escribe de memoria la fórmula de Past Continuous, recupera «It was snowing and the streets were getting icy.» y crea otro ejemplo con vocabulario distinto. Después verifica ambos.

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_____

F17 · RECONSTRUCCIÓN 21: DEL SIGNIFICADO A LA FORMA

Actividad 21. Sin copiar, reconstruye una oración que comunique «No se sentía bien, así que se fue a casa temprano. - Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple)». Después compárala con «She wasn't feeling well, so she went home early.» y subraya la señal que controla la estructura.

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F18 · CONTRASTE MÍNIMO 22: DOS LECTURAS CERCANAS

Actividad 22. Compara «I was working when the power went out.» con «She was reading while he was cooking dinner.». Explica qué cambia entre «Estaba trabajando cuando se fue la luz.» y «Ella estaba leyendo mientras él cocinaba.» y escribe un tercer ejemplo que mantenga el primer patrón.

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_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: was/were selection.

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_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: past cont + when + past simple.

_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: while + simultaneous actions.

_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: Subject + was/were + verb-ing (+ when + past simple).

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R5 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: chronology, viewpoint and reference.

_____
_____

R6 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: connected-text self-correction.

_____
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STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.